

Boriken Geo-Anthropologic Review

Taino Map Project

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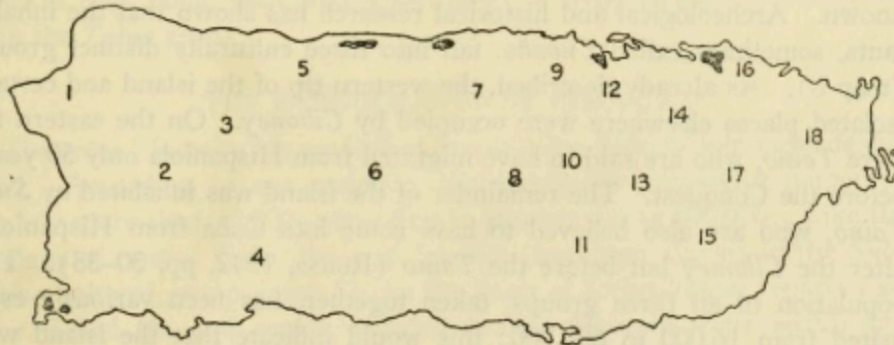
- **How do we know what we know about Yucayeques?**
 - Conquistadors, explorers, and friars wrote detailed journals. They recorded the names of prominent *caciques* (chiefs), noted which rivers or valleys they controlled, and described village structures like *bohios* (huts) and *bateyes* (plaza ball courts).
 - Excavations validate or correct the Spanish texts. Finding *batey* stones, *zemi* religious artifacts, and shell middens allows archaeologists to plot exactly where a village stood, how large it was, and how long it was occupied.
 - Many towns, rivers, and mountains in Puerto Rico still bear their original Taíno names (e.g., Jayuya, Humacao, Utuado, Mayagüez), preserving the memory of the *cacique* who ruled that area. Early Spanish church records (such as baptismal or burial registries) also frequently noted the local region or chiefdom of origin for the indigenous population.
 - The yucayeque boundaries are inferred by cartographers using specific environmental and historical logic, like:
 - Natural geographic boundaries: The Taíno organized their territories around watersheds, valleys, and mountain ridges. Modern historians draw boundaries along major rivers or mountain ranges, as these natural obstacles logically separated one yucayeques resource zone from another.
 - Spheres of Influence: Taíno political structure was regional rather than border-defined. A yucayeque held a sphere of influence over surrounding agricultural lands (*conucos*). Online maps simplify this by drawing a halfway line through the wilderness separating two known neighboring yucayeques.

Sources:

- Yucayekeno Connect: Mapping Boriken's Taino Legacy & Tribal Registration: <https://solve.mit.edu/solutions/89910>
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- Cayetano Coll y Toste. "Guanina" in Maria Teresa Babín (ed.). *Borinquen: An Anthology of Puerto Rican Literature*. New York: Knopf. 1974.
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- <https://www.naciontainodeboriken.org/yucayekenconnect>
- <https://www.discoverpuertorico.com/article/taina-route-indigenous-culture-puerto-rico>
- <https://teachersinstitute.yale.edu/curriculum/units/files/86.02.01.pdf>
- <https://native-land.ca/listings/territories/boriken-taino>

Many interactive or static maps found online are derived from a seminal [1901 Smithsonian Institution Map of Puerto Rico Caciques](#). Early 20th-century researchers mapped the text of Spanish chronicles onto a modern map of Puerto Rico's municipalities.

The names of some of the caciques ("régulos," i.e., chiefs of small states) simultaneously ruling over certain island districts has been preserved. From them a reconstruction has been made of the distribution of the chieftainships, as shown on map 11.



MAP 11.—The principal villages of Puerto Rico and of their chiefs. 1, Aymaco (chief Aymamon); 2, Yagueca (chief Urayoan); 3, Guajataca (chief Mabodamaca); 4, Guaynia (chiefs Agueybana 1 and 2); 5, Abacoa (chief Arasibo); 6, Otoa (chief Guarionex); 7, Sibuco (chief Guacabo); 8, Jatibonico (chief Orocobix); 9, Toa (chief Aramana); 10, Guaynabo (chief Mabo); 11, Guayama (chief Guamani); 12, Bayamon (chief Majagua); 13, Turabo (chief Caguax); 14, Cayniabon (chief Canobana); 15, Guayaney (chief Guaraca); 16, Jaymanio (chieftainess Yuisa); 17, Macao (chief Humacao); 18, Dagua (chief Dagua). (After Coll y Toste, 1907.)

- Smithsonian 1901 map of Puerto Rico caciques
- Source: https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Smithsonian_1901_map_of_Puerto_Rico_caciques.png#

The following list includes: the name of the main yucayeques or villages of Borikén, the current geographical area and the name of the chief who commanded the yucayeque.

1. **AYMACO** (Aguadilla) - Amamón
2. **ABACOA** (Approximately from Quebradillas to Arecibo) - Arasibo
3. **SEBUKO OR CIBUCO** (VegaBaja) - Guacabo
4. **TOA** (VegaAlta) - Aramana
5. **BAYAMON** (ToaAlta/ ToaBaja/Bayamón) - Majagua
6. **GUAYNABO** (Guaynabo) - Mabo
7. **HAIMANÍO** (Loíza) - Yuisa
8. **CAYNABON** (Canóvanas/ RíoGrande) - Canóvana
9. **DAGUAO** (Luquillo/ Fajardo/ Naguabo) - Yuqibo or Yukibo
10. **BIEKE** (Vieques, Culebra) - Cacimar
11. **MACAO** (Humacao) - Humaca or Jamacao
12. **GUAYANEY** (Patillas/Maunabo) - Guaraca or Guanaca
13. **GUAYAMA** (Guayama) - Guamaní
14. **TURABO** (Caguas) - Caguax

15. ATIBONICO OR JATIBONICU (Orocovis/ Barranquitas/ Coamo) - Orocobix

16. OTOAO (SanSebastián/ Lares/ Utuado) - Guarionex

17. GUANÍA (Approximately from Cabo Rojo to Ponce) - Agüeybaná

18. YAGUECAX (Mayagüez) - Urayoán



In addition to these, other smaller yucayeques that depended on the larger ones have been mentioned, such as:

- ABEYNO (Santa Isabel) - Abey
- AMONA (Mona Island) - Amonilla
- CAYECO (Cayey) - Cayey
- COABEY (Jayuya) - Jayuya
- GUAJATACA (Quebradillas) - Mabodamaca
- GUAMÁ (San Germán) - Huamey

Below is a political map of Puerto Rico to help identify the municipalities where the aforementioned yucayeques were located.



Source: <https://www.histopediadepuertorico.com/post/yucayeques-y-caciques-de-borik%C3%A9n>

Other Maps



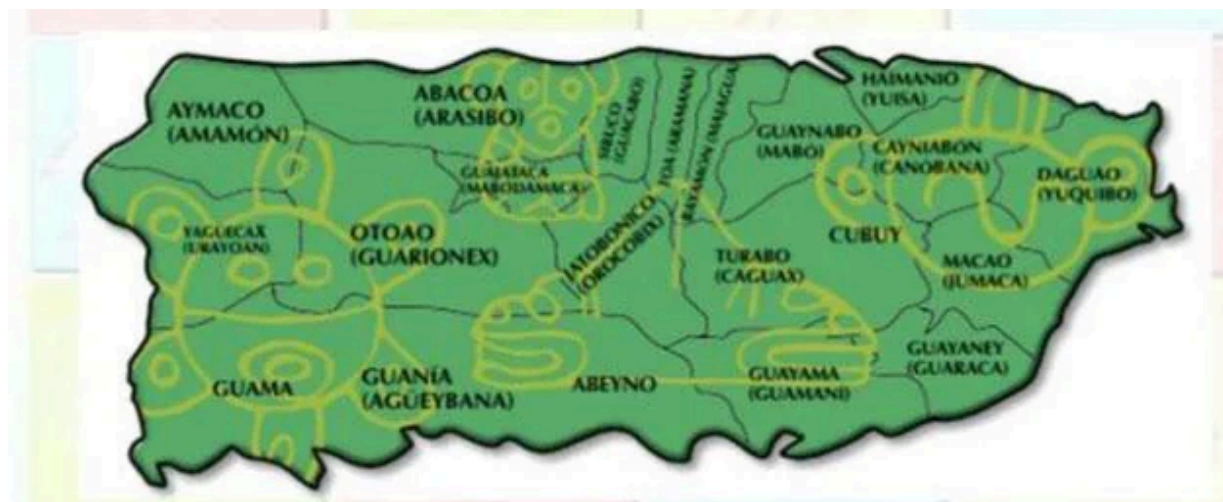
Source:

https://www.reddit.com/r/MapPorn/comments/qfr256/yucayeques_or_chiefdoms_of_the_taino_people_of/



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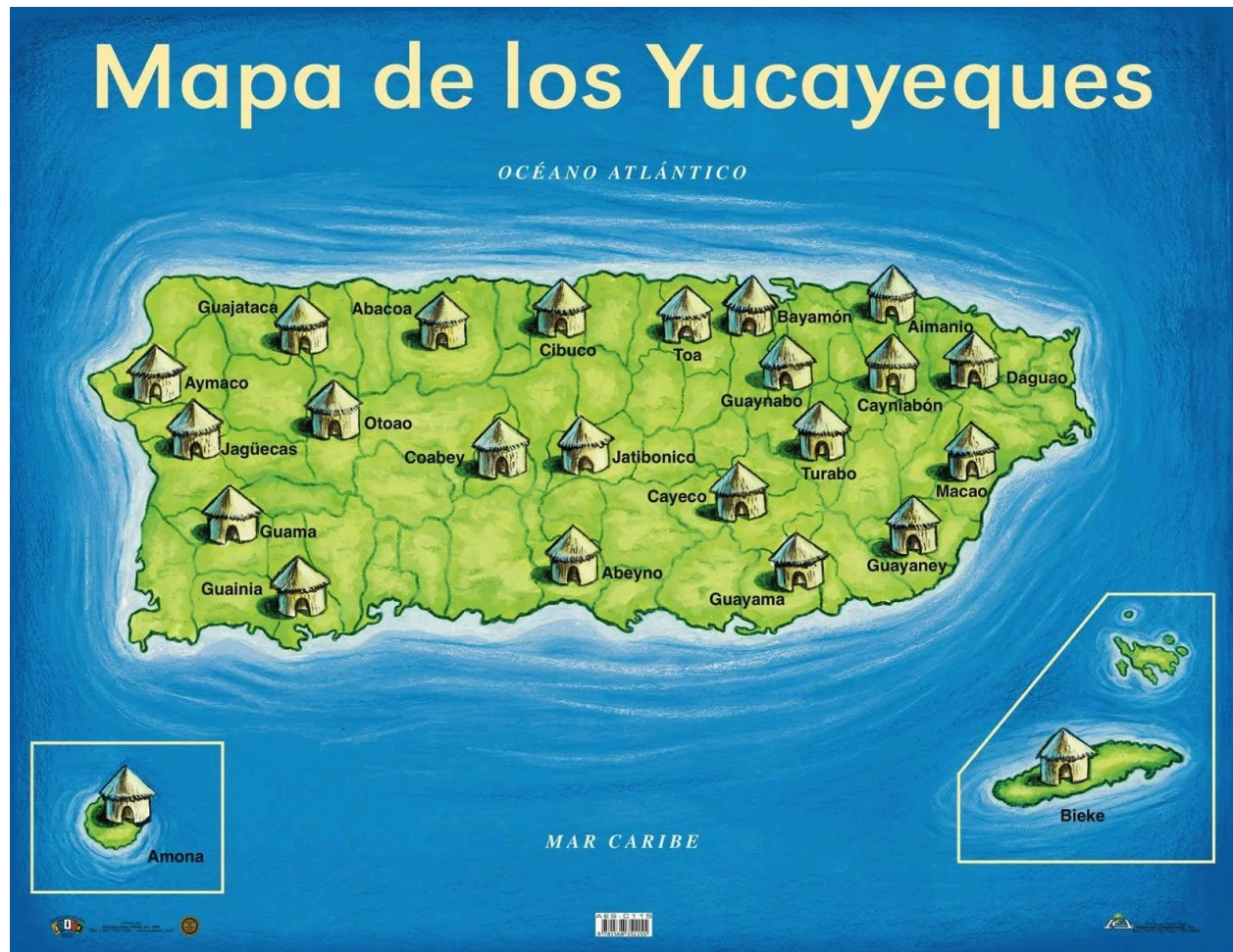
Source:

https://www.reddit.com/r/MapPorn/comments/qfr256/yucayeques_or_chiefdoms_of_the_taino_people_of/



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Source: <http://www.proyectosalohogar.com/link%20p.r/www.linktopr.com/caciques.html>



Source: <https://www.facebook.com/groups/2195791127140494/posts/7669382433114642/>



Source: <https://www.instagram.com/p/CIM1rnPLRF/>

Taíno Territory / Chiefdom	Historical Ruler (Cacique)	Primary Modern Municipalities Included
Guaynía	Agüeybaná I & II (Great Caciques)	Guayanilla, Yauco, Ponce, Guánica, Peñuelas
Sotomayor / Otoao	Guarionex	Utuado, Jayuya, Adjuntas
Aymaco	Aymamón	Aguadilla, Aguada, Moca, Rincón
Abacoa	Arasibo	Arecibo, Hatillo, Camuy, Barceloneta
Cayniabón	Canóbana	Canóvanas, Loíza, Carolina
Turabo	Caguax	Caguas, San Lorenzo, Gurabo
Guaynabo	Mabodamaca	Isabela, Quebradillas, Camuy
Daguao	Daguao & Yuisa (Loíza)	Ceiba, Fajardo, Luquillo, Naguabo, Vieques
Macao	Humacao	Humacao, Yabucoa, Las Piedras